

A BIG DEAL

The high-profile merger between IT majors L&T Infotech and Mindtree to create LTIMindtree has ensured that the merged entity gets a seat at the big table. It competes with the Big Boys of the Indian IT arena now

By **Ashish Rukhaiyar**

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► **THE MEGA MERGER BETWEEN** the erstwhile IT majors Mindtree and Larsen & Toubro Infotech (LTI) was announced in May 2022; its significance for the diversified multinational conglomerate L&T was visible from the fact that none other than then LTI Chairman A.M. Naik and Vice Chairman S.N. Subrahmanyam announced the merger, addressed the media, and took on the barrage of questions.

The two listed entities started operating as a single merged company—now the fifth-largest IT services firm in the country—from November 14, 2022. However, the seeds of the merger were sown much earlier. They had been working together on several deals even before the merger.

It was the pandemic that pushed the clock back. “If Covid-19 had not happened, then the merger of LTI and Mindtree would have happened earlier. The first criterion was that none of the companies should be leaning on each other,” says CEO & MD Debashis Chatterjee.



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► **Bigger and Better, Together**

❶ Even before the formal merger, LTI and Mindtree worked together to bid for deals

❷ The consortium model helped execute the merger scheme in record time

❸ Also, it ensures minimal overlap in terms of clients, expertise, and capabilities